

PROBLEM STATEMENT (ELEMENT A)

Roosevelt's lacrosse team faces challenges during their practices due to the tedious task of retrieving balls. According to their coach, using the balls during practice has been annoying because they constantly have to pick up or roll them to each other, unnecessarily straining their muscles. The lacrosse team struggles with being able to enjoy their usual practice because of the ball dispensing issue. This is why our ball dispenser needs to be able to dispense the ball at the appropriate speed, time, and distance.

This problem currently affects the ERHS lacrosse team and occurs during every practice on Mondays, Wednesdays, and Fridays. This could seem like a minor problem at a glance, but digging deeper will reveal that it affects the team as a whole. The problem occurs during every single after-school lacrosse practice and weekend practice as well. It involves both players and coaches who are straining themselves by bending down and rolling balls to each other during practice. For certain training drills, the coaches have found that rolling the balls has become a necessity.

The problem is happening here at our school, during every lacrosse practice, which is Mondays, Wednesdays, and Fridays. It occurs because of a lack of infrastructure within the school, which would allow the lacrosse team resources to obtain a commercially made ball dispenser. According to players on the lacrosse team, they find themselves picking up balls constantly during practice, and the muscle strain adds to the exhausting effects of rough practices.

The main issue here lies in the fact that the act of picking up balls during practice results in repeated straining of the body, specifically the knees, hips, and lower back. These areas are already common for injury in the sport of lacrosse, (Heather K Vincent, Laura Ann Zdziarski, Kevin R. Vincent; 2014) and the added strain from picking up balls can exacerbate any prospective risks for injury. In addition to putting strain on players and coaches, the problem impacts our stakeholders as it causes practices to run low and be ineffective in improving the players' skills. According to the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention continuous bending down can cause strain to the back. The act of rolling the balls continuously to each individual player is not only time-consuming but also causes some players to have less practice time than the needed amount.